LESSON 9

Modals 2.

Have to and must

Have to do something = it is necessary to do it, one is obliged to do it.

You can't turn right here. You **have to** turn left.

George can't come with us this evening. He **has to** work late.

My grandmother **has to** wear glasses for reading.

We use **do/does/did** in questions and negative sentences.

Do you **have to** work late today?

I **don't have to** wear glasses.

Did you **have to** leave early? But: I **had to** leave early.

Must is similar to **have to**.

We can use **must** to give our opinion (to say what we *think* is necessary, or to recommend someone to do something). **Have to** is also possible.

I haven't spoken to Joe for ages. I **must** phone him. (= I say this is necessary)

Joe is a really kind person. You **must** meet him. (= I recommend this)

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We use **have to** (*not* **must**) to say what someone is *obliged* to do. The speaker is not giving his/her opinion.

I **have to** work from 8.30 to 5.30 every day. (a fact, not an opinion)

We cannot use **must** to talk about the past.

We **had to** leave early. (*not* we **must**)

Mustn't and **don't have to** are completely different.

You **mustn't** do something = it is necessary that you do *not* do it (so don't do it)

You **don't have to** do something = you don't need to do it (but you can if you want)

Compare:

You **must keep** it a secret. You **mustn't tell** anyone. (= don't tell anyone)

You **don't have to** tell him, but you can if you want to.

Must, **mustn't** and **needn't**

You **must** do something = it is necessary that you do it:

We haven't got much time. We **must** hurry.

You **mustn't** do something = it is necessary that you do *not* do it (so don't do it):

We must be very quiet. We **mustn't** make any noise.

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You **needn't** do something = you don't need to do it (but you can if you like):

We've got plenty of time. We **needn't** hurry. (it is not necessary)

Instead of **needn't**, you can use **don't/doesn't need to**.

We **needn't** hurry. or We **don't need to** hurry.

Should

You **should** do something = it is a good thing to do or the right thing to do. You can use **should** to give advice or to give an opinion:

You look tired. You **should** go to bed.

The government **should** do more to reduce crime.

We often use should with **I think / I don't think / Do you think ... ?:**

I don't think you should work so hard.

Do you think I should apply for this job?

You **shouldn't** do something = it isn't a good thing to do:

You **shouldn't** believe everything you read in the newspapers.

Should is not as strong as **must** or **have to**:

You **should** apologise. (= it would be a good thing to do)

You **must** apologise. / You **have to** apologise. (= you have no alternative)

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